Ioannis Ioannou

Associate Professor of Strategy and Entrepreneurship, London Business School

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Speaking and advisory engagements: Stellant

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

May 2016 – present	**Associate Professor of Strategy and Entrepreneurship (with tenure)** London Business School
Sept 2021 – May 2022	**Visiting Associate Professor of Management** Miami Herbert Business School, University of Miami
Mar 2018 – Jun 2018	**Visiting Scholar** ESMT Berlin
Aug 2009 – Apr 2016	**Assistant Professor of Strategy and Entrepreneurship** London Business School
Feb 2012 – May 2012	**Visiting Scholar** Harvard Business School

EDUCATION

2009	**PhD in Business Economics**, Harvard University
2008	**M.A. in Economics**, Harvard University
2003	**B.A. in Economics and Mathematics**, *magna cum laude*, Yale University

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

Research	Corporate sustainability · Corporate social responsibility · Financial markets and asset management · ESG integration · Sustainability and ESG reporting
Teaching	Sustainability · Corporate social responsibility · General management · Business strategy · Disruptive innovation · Strategy with AI · Strategy execution with AI

EDITORIAL ROLES

Jan 2026 – Dec 2028	**Guest Associate Editor**, *Strategic Management Journal*
2024 – present	**Associate Editor (Sustainability)**, *Management Science*
2023 – present	**Consulting Editor**, *Journal of International Business Studies*
2022 – present	**Editor**, *Accountability in a Sustainable World Quarterly*
2018 – present	**Editorial Board**, *Academy of Management Perspectives*
2020 – 2025	**Associate Editor (two three-year terms)**, *Strategic Management Journal*
2016 – 2020	**Senior Editor**, *Organization & Environment*
2013 – 2019	**Editorial Board**, *Strategic Management Journal*

ADVISORY AND EXPERT ROLES

May 2026 – present	**Member, Academic Network Advisory Committee** United Nations Principles for Responsible Investment (PRI)
Mar 2026 – present	**Senior Advisor** Lucid Axon

Nov 2025 – present	**Member, Net Positive Advisory Panel** Capgemini
Jul 2025 – present	**Strategic Advisor** SustainGRC
May 2025 – present	**Member, Academic Advisory Panel** UN PRI: Sustainability-Linked Value Creation in Private Markets
May 2025 – present	**Member, FASTtrack to 2050 Taskforce** Accounting for Sustainability (A4S): Narratives and Behaviours
May 2025 – present	**Senior Academic Advisor** Evolution Ltd.
May 2023 – present	**Member, Advisory Council** European Institute of Management and Finance (EIMF)
Aug 2021 – present	**Co-Chair, Sustainability Advisory Panel** Merck KGaA
Sept 2018 – present	**Member, Expert Network on Sustainable Development** World Economic Forum (WEF)

PAST ROLES

Nov 2024 – Dec 2025	**Member, Board of Advisors** Qurator.com
2015 – 2025	**Board Member (2018 – 2025), Secretary (2022 – 2025) and Communications Committee member** Alliance for Research on Corporate Sustainability (ARCS)
Nov 2020 – Dec 2024	**Member, ESG Advisory Board** DWS Group
2016 – 2021	**Member, Advisory Board** Ethical Corporation
2020	**Member, Stakeholder Working Group** UK Treasury's Asset Management Taskforce
2020	**Member, Advisory Board** Sustainable Risk Assessment Framework (SRAF)
2015	**Member, External Transparency Challenge Panel** Network Rail (UK)
2014	**Member, Prosperity Panel** Advising the Minister of the Environment of Northern Ireland

PUBLICATIONS

Citations (as of 13 October 2026): Google Scholar 26,709 · Web of Science 8,767

Profiles: Google Scholar · SSRN · ORCID

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

1. "CSR Decoupling within Business Groups and the Risk of Perceived Greenwashing", with V.-A. Porumb, J. Bothello and Y. Zengin-Karaibrahimoglu, *Strategic Management Journal*, 2023, 44(13): 3217–3251
   2023 Top Cited SMJ Article
2. "Retrospective: What Drives Corporate Social Performance? The Role of Nation-Level Institutions", with G. Serafeim, *Journal of International Business Studies*, 2023, 54: 14–23
   Retrospective on the 2012 paper, winner of the JIBS 2022 Decade Award
3. "The Impact of Perceived Greenwashing on Customer Satisfaction and the Contingent Role of Capability Reputation", with G. Kassinis and G. Papagiannakis, *Journal of Business Ethics*, 2023, 185(2): 333–347

4. "Strategic Management During the Financial Crisis: How Firms Adjust their Strategic Investments in Response to Credit Market Disruptions", with C. Flammer, *Strategic Management Journal*, 2021, 42(7): 1275–1298
   Top Cited SMJ Article, 2021–2022
5. "Willing and Able: A General Model of Organizational Responses to Normative Pressures", with O. Hawn and R. Durand, *Academy of Management Review*, 2019, 44(2): 299–320
6. "Mind the Gap: The Interplay Between External and Internal Actions in the Case of Corporate Social Responsibility", with O. Hawn, *Strategic Management Journal*, 2016, 37(13): 2569–2588
7. "The Effect of Target Difficulty on Target Completion: The Case of Reducing Carbon Emissions", with X. Li and G. Serafeim, *The Accounting Review*, 2016, 91(5): 1467–1492
8. "The Impact of Corporate Social Responsibility on Investment Recommendations: Analysts' Perceptions and Shifting Institutional Logics", with G. Serafeim, *Strategic Management Journal*, 2015, 36(7): 1053–1081
   Ranked as the #6 most cited paper in the Strategic Management Journal for 2014–2018
9. "The Impact of Corporate Sustainability on Organizational Processes and Performance", with R. Eccles and G. Serafeim, *Management Science*, 2014, 60(11): 2835–2857
   Ranked as the #2 most cited paper in Management Science for 2014–2018
10. "When Do Spinouts Enhance Parent Firm Performance? Evidence from the US Automobile Industry, 1890–1986", *Organization Science*, 2014, 25(2): 529–551
11. "Corporate Social Responsibility and Access to Finance", with B. Cheng and G. Serafeim, *Strategic Management Journal*, 2014, 35(1): 1–23 (Lead Article)
    Ranked as the #1 most cited paper in the Strategic Management Journal for 2014–2018; Emerald Citations of Excellence Award, 2017
12. "What Drives Corporate Social Performance? The Role of Nation-Level Institutions", with G. Serafeim, *Journal of International Business Studies*, 2012, 43: 834–864
    Winner of the 2022 JIBS Decade Award (award announcement)
13. "The Effects of Capacity on Sales under Alternative Vertical Contracts", with J. H. Mortimer and R. Mortimer, *Journal of Industrial Economics*, 2011, 59(1): 117–154
14. "A Textbook Example of International Price Discrimination", with C. Cabolis, S. Clerides and D. Senft, *Economics Letters*, 2007, 95(1): 91–95

Book Chapters

1. "Beyond the Business Case: Rebuilding the Foundations of Corporate Sustainability", in D. Gitterman and S. Shah (eds.), *edited volume*, Brookings Institution Press, forthcoming
2. "Leaders as System-Shapers: Creating the Conditions for Sustainability", invited contribution in M. Balisciano, C. Leitz and C. Scott, *Navigating the Business of Sustainability: A Practitioner's Guide*, Elsevier, forthcoming (January 2027)
3. "Redefining Strategy in the Age of Sustainability and Social Responsibility", with O. Hawn, in *Oxford Handbook of Corporate Social Responsibility: Psychological and Organizational Perspectives*, Oxford University Press, 2019
4. "The Consequences of Mandatory Corporate Sustainability Reporting: Evidence from Four Countries", with G. Serafeim, in *Oxford Handbook of Corporate Social Responsibility: Psychological and Organizational Perspectives*, Oxford University Press, 2019
5. "Drivers of Corporate Sustainability and Implications for Capital Markets", with G. Serafeim, in R. G. Eccles, B. Cheng and D. Saltzman (eds.), *The Landscape of Integrated Reporting: Reflections and Next Steps*, Cambridge, MA, 2010

Practitioner Publications

1. "How Leaders Can Create a Purpose-Driven Culture", with R. Durand, *Harvard Business Review*, November 2023
2. "How Some Companies Avoid Accusations of Greenwashing", with V.-A. Porumb, J. Bothello and Y. Zengin-Karaibrahimoglu, *Harvard Business Review*, September 2023
3. "How Greenwashing Affects the Bottom Line", with G. Kassinis and G. Papagiannakis, *Harvard Business Review*, July 2022

4. "How VCs Can Help Startups Set (and Meet) ESG Goals", with L. Alemany and O. Kacperczyk, *Harvard Business Review*, January 2022
5. "Save or Invest? How Companies Should Navigate Recessions", with C. Flammer, *Harvard Business Review*, May 2019 (online)
6. "Yes, Sustainability Can Be A Strategy", with G. Serafeim, *Harvard Business Review*, February 2019

Holding the Line: A Playbook for ESG Leadership in Hostile Terrain, London Business School, 2025 (practitioner playbook and online self-assessment)

Best Paper Proceedings, Academy of Management

1. "Different Shades of Green: A General Model of Organizational Responses to Normative Pressures", with R. Durand and O. Hawn, ONE Division, 2016
2. "Do Actions Speak Louder Than Words? The Case of CSR!", with O. Hawn, SIM Division, 2012 (Best Paper Award)
3. "The Impact of Corporate Social Responsibility on Investment Recommendations", with G. Serafeim, SIM Division, 2010
4. "The Impact of Different Types of Spinoffs on Firm Survival: US Automobile Industry 1890–1986", BPS Division, 2009 (Distinguished Student Paper Award)

WORKING PAPERS

1. "Bad News, Now What? Responding to Multiple ESG Criticisms and Issues", with O. Hawn and R. Durand, *second revision under review at Academy of Management Perspectives (resubmitted September 2026)*
2. "Reaffirming the link between CSR and Access to Finance: A Response to the AK (2025) Commentary", with George Serafeim (HBS), *Revise and Resubmit at Strategic Management Journal*
3. "Trapped Capabilities: Capability Valuation Under Socioecological Misalignment", with L. Nardi, *under review at Strategic Management Journal*
4. "How Gaming Spreads: Isomorphic Pressures and the Design of Organizational Evaluation Systems", with J. Bothello and L. Bonfim, *under review at Journal of Management*
5. "When Gaming Outruns Repair: A Dynamic Theory of Organizational Evaluation Systems", with J. Bothello and L. Bonfim, *preparing for submission to Strategic Management Journal*
6. "Frames That Bind: When Climate-Risk Framing Drives Green Innovation", with G. Tian, Q. Xiao and H. Shen, *preparing for submission to Strategic Management Journal*
7. "From Sustainability to Compliance: How Peer Environmental Regulatory Sanctions Reshape Environmental Hiring in Non-Sanctioned Firms", with W. Shi and B. Li, *being revised for submission to Strategic Management Journal*
8. "The Social Construction of Financial Materiality: How Environmental and Social Issues Become Financially Material, and Why They Sometimes Cease to Be", with F. Ferraro and E. Marti, *working paper*
9. "Contrasting Cues, Similar Stakes: Corporate Social Performance and Equity Ownership Stake Sought in M&As", with C. Li and R. Saling, *working paper*
10. "Sustainability-based Differentiation: Maintaining Competitive Advantage in the Face of Industry Convergence", with G. Serafeim and R. Durand, *working paper*
11. "Talk Is Not Always Cheap: What Firms Say, How They Say It, And Social Performance", with D. Crilly, *working paper*

HONOURS AND AWARDS

2026	Top 10 Thought Leaders in Sustainable Business, illuminem
2026	Best Reviewer Award, Academy of Management Perspectives
2025	Teaching Award, Financial Times Responsible Business Education Awards
2025	Best Reviewer Award, Academy of Management Perspectives
2024	LinkedIn Top Voice, Sustainability & Business

2023	#7 in Onalytica's "Who's Who in ESG? Top 50 Influencers to Follow"
2022	Highly Cited Researcher, Clarivate (Web of Science): top 0.1% of researchers across 21 fields
2022	JIBS 2022 Decade Award, for "What Drives Corporate Social Performance? The Role of Nation-Level Institutions", with G. Serafeim
2019	Outstanding Member, Best Reviewer Award, Strategic Management Journal Editorial Board
2018	Nominated, Research Impact on Practice Award, ONE Division (Academy of Management) and Network for Business Sustainability, for "Willing and Able", with O. Hawn and R. Durand
2017	Nominated, Research Impact on Practice Award, ONE Division (Academy of Management) and Network for Business Sustainability, for "Mind the Gap", with O. Hawn
2017	Emerald Citations of Excellence Award, for "Corporate Social Responsibility and Access to Finance" (SMJ, 2014)
2016	ARCS Emerging Sustainability Scholar Award
2016	ARCS Outstanding Paper Award, for Durand, Hawn and Ioannou (2016)
2016	Best Paper Proceedings, Academy of Management, ONE Division, for Durand, Hawn and Ioannou (2016)
2015	Outstanding Member Award, Strategic Management Journal Editorial Board
2015	Nominated, Best Conference Paper Prize, Strategic Management Society, for "The Dog That Didn't Bark: Long-Term Strategies in Times of Recession", with C. Flammer
2013	Shortlisted, Thinkers50 Future Thinker Award
2013	ECCH Award, Best-Selling Case of 2012, for "DESSO (A) – Taking on the Sustainability Challenge", with A. Ody-Brasier
2012	Best Paper Award, SIM Division, Academy of Management, for Hawn and Ioannou (2011)
2011	Best Conference Paper, PRI-Mistra/SIRP Academic Conference, United Nations PRI
2011	Best Reviewer Award, SIM Division, Academy of Management
2010	Best Paper Proceedings, Academy of Management, SIM Division, for Ioannou and Serafeim (2010)
2009	Distinguished Student Paper Award, BPS Division, Academy of Management, for Ioannou (2008)
2009	Best Paper Proceedings, Academy of Management, BPS Division, for Ioannou (2008)
2006	Nominated for the Bok Prize, awarded to the best Teaching Fellow across all Harvard departments
2005 – 2006	Three Certificates for Distinction in Teaching, Bok Center, Harvard University
2003 – 2008	Harvard Business School (Wyss) Doctoral Student Fellowship
1999 – 2003	CASP/Fulbright Scholar, full scholarship for undergraduate degree

TEACHING

Degree Programmes, London Business School

- **Managing and Investing in Responsible Businesses** (elective, E515), designed with A. Edmans in 2019 and co-taught with him 2020 – 2021; now co-taught with M. Groen-Xu
- **Sustainability Leadership** (elective, E630), built on alumni cases
- **EMBA Capstone**, co-taught with Y. Mylonadis
- **Global Experiences**: Stockholm; Singapore and Malaysia (Sustainability in Global Value Chains, co-taught)
- **Economic Foundations of Strategy** (PhD course), co-developed and co-taught with M. Jacobides, 2016 – 2017 and 2023; co-taught with X. Li, 2025
- **Organizing the Climate Transition** (Business Schools for Climate Leadership online PhD course), guest sessions, 2025 – 2026
- **Previously taught**: Strategic Management (core MBA, 2010 – 2012, 2016 – 2017; EMBA Dubai, 2015, 2020 – 2021); Strategic Innovation (elective, 2016); Strategy for Masters in Finance (elective, 2010 – 2018); Managing Responsibly / Perspectives on Business Ethics (MBA core, 2017 – 2021); International Assignment, Cape Town (lead, 2015); Global Business Assignment, San Francisco (co-lead, 2018, 2019, 2021)

Executive Education

- **Sustainability Leadership and Corporate Responsibility** (online programme; designer and lead faculty), more than 1,000 senior leaders and board members enrolled (www.london.edu/SLCR)
- **Strategy for Emerging Leaders**, London Business School executive programme
- **Open programmes**, London Business School: Senior Executive Programme; Accelerated Development Programme; Emerging Leaders Programme; Next Generation Digital Strategies
- Custom programmes for clients including ADQ, Air Liquide, Aramco, Arla Foods, Banque Saudi Fransi, Barclays, Bridgestone, Ericsson, ENGIE, Euroclear, FL Consulting, FrieslandCampina, HSBC, IBM, Jardine Matheson, Kingfisher, Mölnlycke, Orica, pladis, Porsche Holding Salzburg, Royal Academy of Management (Oman), Siam Cement Group, Sistema Ocemg (Brazil), TAQA, Vodafone and the World Economic Forum (Global Leadership Fellows)

DOCTORAL SUPERVISION AND EXAMINING

Current	**PhD supervisor**, Grace Headinger, London Business School
2016 – 2022	**PhD supervisor**, Kevin Chuah, London Business School (placement: Northeastern University)
2026	**External member, PhD thesis committee**, Alireza Mahmoodzadeh, Esade Business School
2025	**External member, PhD examination committee**, Loukia Bakalouri, University of Cyprus
2017	**External member, PhD thesis committee**, Horacio Rousseau, IESE Business School
2016 – 2023	**Doctoral committees, London Business School**: second-year paper committee (A. Kapacinskaite, 2016/17); committee member and letter writer (P. Anders, 2018/19); qualifying exam committees (2018/19, 2022/23)

TEACHING MATERIALS

Case Studies (London Business School)

- "Oyster becomes a unicorn: fundraising for an impact-driven enterprise", with L. Alemany, N. Andreou and N. Mickshik, CS-25-001 (with Teaching Note)
- "Avon International: Imagining a Refill Program in Turkey", with K. Mark and L. Duke, CS-24-023
- "Pentland Brands: Berghaus's International Expansion", with K. Mark, CS-24-024
- "The Hasslacher Group: The Capital Equipment Decision", with K. Mark, CS-24-022
- "Flakk Group (A): Hexagon Purus – Fuelling the Future", with N. Mickshik, CS-24-006
- "Flakk Group (B): Norwegian Hydrogen", with N. Mickshik, CS-24-007
- "Lark & Berry: The diamond disruptors", with N. Mickshik, CS-23-020 (with Teaching Note)
- "Treeapp: Plant a Tree for Free, Every Day", with N. Mickshik, CS-21-012
- "DESSO (A) – Taking on the Sustainability Challenge", with A. Ody-Brasier, CS-11-029
- "DESSO (B) – Going Forward", with A. Ody-Brasier, CS-11-030
- "Tarkett – The Challenge of Implementing Corporate Values", with N. Deakin and A. Kapacinkaite

INVITED ACADEMIC SEMINARS AND LECTURES

2026	HEC Paris
2025	University of Mannheim Business School
2024	Stockholm School of Economics; Copenhagen Business School, Leadership Think Tank (keynote); Norwegian School of Economics (NHH) and ENGAGE.EU (keynote); Hong Kong University of Science and Technology; Alliance Manchester Business School; ISOI and HEC Paris Conference on Corporate Purpose and Sustainable Capitalism, University of Illinois (panel)
2023	Tuck School of Business at Dartmouth; Oxford Reputation Conference; University of Liverpool
2022	Financial Conduct Authority, Sustainable Finance Research Symposium; ARCS Virtual Seminar Series

2021	Bocconi University; University of Miami Herbert Business School; Singapore Management University; University of Mannheim; University of Wyoming; IESE–ECGI Conference on Boards of Directors and Corporate Strategy; Harvard Kennedy School, M-RCBG Senior Fellow-led Study Group
2019	Birkbeck, University of London; University of Groningen; Universitat Pompeu Fabra; Aalto University; Strategica International Conference, Bucharest (keynote); First Symposium on Business and Society, Spanish Academy of Management, Granada (keynote)
2018	University of Leeds; ESMT Berlin, Sustainable Business Roundtable
2017	Norwegian School of Economics, FIBA annual conference (keynote); INSEAD Social Innovation Centre; University of Antwerp; University of Nottingham Ningbo China; Copenhagen Business School; FHWien der WKW, Vienna
2016	Hong Kong Baptist University, International Corporate Governance Conference; Bar-Ilan University, Ackerman Conference on Corporate Governance
2015	HEC Lausanne; Cardiff Business School, Finance Workshop; Cass Business School; ESMT Berlin, conference and round-table; George Washington University, CSR speaker series; ABIS Colloquium, Milan
2014	National University of Singapore Business School; INSEAD Singapore; HKUST Finance Conference, Hong Kong
2013	University of Exeter Business School; ESMT Berlin; Birkbeck, University of London; ESADE; Universitat Pompeu Fabra; University of Edinburgh Business School, Sustainable Business Conference (closing keynote)
2012	Cass Business School; Cardiff Business School; INSEAD, Fontainebleau; Cranfield School of Management; Nottingham Trent University; EABIS–IMD Colloquium, Lausanne (plenary)
2011	University of St Andrews, Centre for Responsible Banking and Finance; Warwick Business School, Frontiers of Finance; University of Cyprus; UC Berkeley Haas and Maastricht University, Finance and Responsible Business Conference (discussant)
2010	Cass Business School, International Strategy Workshop

SELECTED KEYNOTES AND INVITED TALKS

Represented for speaking and advisory engagements by Stellant

2026	Global CSR Forum, Riyadh (fireside chat and plenary panel)
2026	Keynote, SHARE Investor Summit, Toronto
2026	Keynote, Global Sustainability Forum, Piedmont
2026	Invited speaker, EU Council Working Party on the 2030 Agenda
2026	Panel, KPMG and WBCSD, London Climate Action Week
2025	Plenary speaker, UN PRI in Person, São Paulo
2025	Keynote, Novisto ESG Forum, Montréal
2025	Keynote, Great Corporate Responsibility Day, Finland Chamber of Commerce, Helsinki
2025	Keynote, ShareAction, London Climate Action Week
2025	Panel, UN Global Compact Network UK Annual General Meeting, London
2025	Panel, Techarena, Stockholm
2025	Panel, Exponential Roadmap Initiative, London Climate Action Week
2025	Keynote, 5th Athens ESG Forum (virtual)
2025	Keynote, FRAME 2025 (VentureESG), London
2025	Panel, Responsible Asset Owners Europe (RAO Europe), London
2025	Keynote fireside chat, AmCham Greece 23rd Corporate Responsibility Conference (virtual)
2025	Keynote, EQT webinar “Sustainability in Transition: What’s Next for Private Markets” (virtual)
2025	Keynote fireside chat, Datamaran ESG community event, London
2024	Keynote, Croatian Chamber of Economy, Zagreb

2024	Main stage panel; Biodiversity and Innovation Workshop (organiser), Innovation Zero, London
2024	Panel, Blue Earth Summit, London
2024	Keynote, “Can ESG Stand the Test of Time?”, Directors’ Series (EIMF), Nicosia
2024	Keynote, Conscious Living event (Puig), Barcelona
2024	Speaker, Financial Times and Business Declares roundtable, London
2023	Keynote to the board and C-suite, Danske Bank, Copenhagen
2023	Keynote, ESG Congress, Berlin
2023	Panel, Risk and Resilience 2023 (Board Agenda), London
2023	Keynote (recorded), Reckitt Sustainability Summit
2022	Keynote, Católica Lisbon Perspectives (with BRISA), Lisbon
2021	Host, “Beyond COP26” fireside chats with S. Harford (UBS Asset Management), V. Helias (Procter & Gamble) and L. Jackson (Apple), Miami Herbert Business School (virtual)
2021	Keynote fireside chat, Diageo (virtual)
2021	Talk to the strategy and sustainability leadership team, Schneider Electric (virtual)
2021	Keynote masterclass, EXAME “Melhores do ESG”, Brazil (virtual)
2021	Panel with R. Henderson, Harvard Social Enterprise Conference (virtual)
2020	Keynote, Moody’s Investors Service EMEA Convention, London
2020	Keynote, Rothschild & Co Redburn ESG Conference (virtual)
2020	Keynote conversation, BusinessGreen Net Zero Festival (virtual)
2019	Keynote, Factor Symposium (Goldman Sachs and BlackRock), London
2019	Panel, FT Future of Retail Summit, London
2019	Presentation, Advisory Council, AQR Asset Management Institute, London Business School
2019	Panel, Centre for the Study of Financial Innovation (CSFI), London
2019	Presentation, HM Treasury Net Zero Review team, London
2019	Keynote, Malta Sustainability Forum (APS Bank)
2019	Keynote, Saastamoinen Foundation (Aalto University Executive Education), Espoo
2019	Keynote, AQR Capital Management offsite, London
2019	Panel, Chatham House Responsible Business Conference, London
2019	Keynote, “The Great Indoors” (Tarkett), London
2018	Keynote, Global Islamic Finance Forum, Kuala Lumpur
2017	Keynote, UBS Quantitative Investment Conference, London
2017	Speaker, FIM Partners Annual Investor Conference, Dubai
2017	Keynote panel, Global Investors Forum, Montreux
2017	Speaker, European Pensions & Investments Summit, Montreux
2017	Speaker, Cyprus Government Conference on CSR and Sustainability Reporting, Nicosia
2017	Speaker, Integrating ESG into Private Equity Summit (SuperReturn International), Berlin
2017	Keynote, Annual Corporate Law Conference (Oslo Børs), Oslo
2016	Keynote, Guardian Sustainable Business supplier sustainability event, London
2016	Keynote, Durrell business breakfast (with RBC), Jersey
2015	Speaker, European Commission Multi-Stakeholder Forum on CSR, Brussels
2013	Keynote, HEC Paris Sustainable Business Conference, Paris
2013	Speaker, Responsible Investment Summit, Cambridge Judge Business School
2012	Keynote, World Adhesives Conference (CEO lunch), Paris
2011	Speaker, European Commission (DG Internal Market) expert meeting on non-financial reporting, Brussels

SERVICE TO LONDON BUSINESS SCHOOL

2023 – present	MBA Sustainability and ESG Concentration Coordinator

2023 – present	Member, LBS Sustainability Steering Group
2021 – 2023	School Representative, Business Schools for Climate Leadership (BS4CL)
2019 – 2021	Member, Inclusion and Diversity Committee (Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging Committee from 2021)
2019 – 2020	Member, Hybrid Teaching Working Group
2018 – 2019	Member, LBS Diversity Working Group; LBS/RCA MBA and Design Working Group; Strategy and Entrepreneurship area retreat and internal conference co-organiser
2017 – 2018	Strategy and Entrepreneurship Area PhD Co-coordinator and member of the PhD Committee
2016 – 2017	Curriculum Development Workstream (MBA Programme Review); Core Ethics Course Curriculum Committee; Faculty Retreat Organiser; Faculty IT Group
2012 – 2014	Member, MBA Curriculum Committee (Strategy and Entrepreneurship representative)
2011 – 2012	Member, Research Ethics Committee
From 2010	Confidential Advisor, Bullying and Harassment Code of Practice

Faculty adviser: Net Impact Club (since 2010); Out in Business Club, Advisory Board (since 2016); Social Impact Hub (since 2018)

CONFERENCES ORGANISED

2026	Roundtable, "Are Europe's sustainability ambitions being matched by where capital is actually going?", LBS, Reframe Venture and Sifted (co-convener, with J. Lenhard)
2025 – 2026	Leaders' Roundtable series, London Business School (co-chair, with K. E. Wilson and R. Addis)
2023	BS4CL Climate Research Conference and Forum, hosted by IESE, Barcelona (LBS representative and head of the research committee)
2019	Responsible Business Conference, London Business School (with the LBS Centre for Corporate Governance)
2019	Breakfast roundtable, "Climate-related risk: responsibility of the board, or not?", London (with Harvey Nash and the LBS Leadership Institute)
2016	Organizations with Purpose Conference, London Business School (with Blueprint and R. Henderson, Harvard Business School)
2013	Sustainability and the Corporation: Big Ideas, Harvard Business School (with G. Serafeim)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

2020	Track Co-Chair, Social Issues in Management, Strategic Management Society Annual Conference, London
2016 – 2018	Elected Representative-at-Large, Stakeholder Strategy Interest Group, Strategic Management Society
2013	Track Co-Chair, Strategic Management Society Annual Conference, Atlanta
2012 – 2015	Core Academic Team, Schmidt-MacArthur Fellowship on the Circular Economy

Award juries: Grand Jury, Big Syn International Film Festival (2019 – 2026); Judging Panel, Datamaran European Community Awards (2025); Judging Panel, ESG Investing Awards (2020, 2021); Judge, Outreach Award, ONE and SIM Divisions, Academy of Management (2020, 2021); Senior Judging Panel, Alquity Transforming Lives Awards (2019); Final Judging Panel, Ethical Corporation Annual Awards (2016, 2019); Judging Panel, Nespresso Sustainability MBA Challenge (2013, 2014); Selection Panel, Deloitte Social Innovation Pioneers (2011 – 2012)

External evaluator: tenure and promotion cases at international business schools

Memberships: Academy of Management; Strategic Management Society; Deloitte Institute of Innovation and Entrepreneurship, London Business School

Ad hoc reviewer: Academy of Management Review, Administrative Science Quarterly, Management Science, Journal of Business Ethics, Journal of Cultural Economics, Journal of International Business Studies, Journal of Strategy and Management, Industrial and Corporate Change, Journal of Corporate Finance, Organization Science, Organization Studies, Journal of Management Studies, Journal of Banking and Finance, The Accounting Review, European Accounting Review, Strategy Science, MIT Sloan Management Review

SELECTED MEDIA

- Agency By Design: Leading Through Structural Change, with K. E. Wilson and R. Addis, Forbes, September 2026
- Why the Gulf Has a Strategic Advantage in a Fragmented Decarbonisation World, The National, August 2026
- Quoted in AI Giants Are Quiet on Climate in Sign of Post-ESG Wall Street, Bloomberg Green, August 2026
- Net Zero Was The Easy Part, Forbes, May 2026
- The Canary in the Lecture Hall: What the AI Crisis Scenario Means for Business Academia, Poets&Quants, March 2026
- While Big Tech Burns Cash on AI, Apple Waits, Fortune, February 2026
- From Disruption To Coercion: The New Rules of Business, illuminem, January 2026
- Can Investors Get Sustainability Right in 2026?, Sustainability Wired Podcast (Clarity AI), January 2026
- Companies need coherence — fragmentation is still a structural risk, Financial Times Sustainable Views, December 2025
- Beyond Greenwashing: How ESG Became a Corporate Battleground, LBS Think Ahead Podcast, September 2025
- Trapped Competencies: The Strategic Advantage Markets Cannot Yet See, Forbes, September 2025
- A New Economic Logic for Sustainability, Project Syndicate, August 2025
- Why the ESG Consensus Collapsed—And What That Reveals About Power, Les Echos, 2025
- The Sustainability Counter-Revolution: How Systems Learn to Resist Change, ESG News, 2025
- Financial Market Misalignment With Reality Is The Real Problem Not ESG, Forbes, November 2024
- Navigating The Crossroads: How COP28 Could Shape Business Climate Strategy, Forbes, November 2023
- Firms must not let the fear of greenwashing allegations inhibit their sustainability work, Raconteur, June 2023
- Pride And Prejudice: The Corporate Struggle For LGBTQ+ Rights, Forbes, May 2023
- The Climate Crisis and the Need to Reimagine Our Global Institutions, Forbes, August 2022
- ESG is Not a Distraction, Board Agenda, July 2022
- Energy Crisis Should Not Force Nations to Sacrifice Green Targets, Forbes, April 2022
- Sustainability: from buzzwords to business strategy, Think LBS, October 2021
- Educating Boards and Executives on ESG: Interview with Ioannis Ioannou, Datamaran, May 2020
- Podcast interview with The Sustainability Agenda, May 2020
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- Purpose in Practice: Four Fundamental Principles, Forbes, November 2016
- Interview on the Volkswagen emissions scandal, BBC World News, October 2015
- “Le cercle vertueux de la responsabilité sociale”, Le Monde, July 2013
- “Is sustainability now the key to corporate success?”, The Guardian, January 2012

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

May 2007 – Aug 2007	Associate / PhD Intern, Strategy Team, Analysis Group, Boston, MA
Jun 2003 – Aug 2003	Research Analyst, Synovate International Ltd, Nicosia, Cyprus
Jul 2001 – Aug 2001	Summer Intern, Société Générale Cyprus Ltd, Nicosia, Cyprus
Jun 2000 – Aug 2000	Market Analyst Intern, Middle East Market Research Bureau (MEMRB), Nicosia, Cyprus
Jul 1997 – Aug 1999	Adjunct to Head Personnel Officer, National Guard, Army of the Republic of Cyprus

LANGUAGES

Greek (native) · English (fluent) · French (fluent) · Turkish (beginner)

EXECUTIVE BIOGRAPHY

Dr. Ioannis Ioannou is Associate Professor of Strategy and Entrepreneurship at London Business School, where he has taught since 2009 and received tenure in 2016. He holds a PhD in Business Economics and an M.A. in Economics from Harvard University, and a B.A. in Economics and Mathematics, magna cum laude, from Yale University. He has held visiting appointments at Harvard Business School, ESMT Berlin and the University of Miami.

Dr. Ioannou's work addresses a question that boards and investors now face directly: how companies create and protect long-term value as environmental and social pressures reshape markets, capital and competition. In his research, he examines when sustainability improves a company's financial performance, its access to capital and the way investors assess it. He has also studied credibility: the gap between what companies say and do, the cost of greenwashing, and how disclosure and targets affect delivery. A further line of his work looks at how institutions, regulation and social pressure shape corporate behaviour, and how firms adjust their strategy in a crisis. He is now working on ESG criticism and backlash, on how issues become financially material, and on how markets value capabilities they have yet to recognise.

He has published in the leading journals of strategy, management, international business and accounting. These include the Strategic Management Journal, Management Science, the Academy of Management Review, the Journal of International Business Studies and The Accounting Review. His work has been cited more than 26,000 times on Google Scholar, and several of his articles rank among the most cited in their journals. In 2022, Clarivate named him a Highly Cited Researcher, a distinction held by about 0.1% of researchers worldwide. He is Associate Editor for Sustainability at Management Science and Guest Associate Editor at the Strategic Management Journal, where he previously completed two terms as Associate Editor. He also writes for practitioners, with six articles in Harvard Business Review.

Dr. Ioannou holds ten advisory and expert roles with companies, investors, professional bodies and policy networks. At Merck KGaA, he has co-chaired the Sustainability Advisory Panel since 2021, and in 2025 he joined Capgemini's Net Positive Advisory Panel. He is also a member of two advisory bodies of the UN Principles for Responsible Investment and of the World Economic Forum's Expert Network on Sustainable Development. He advises younger firms in ESG analytics, governance software and strategy consulting. Earlier, he sat on DWS Group's ESG Advisory Board and on panels advising the UK Treasury and other public bodies.

Teaching senior executives has been part of his work throughout his career at London Business School. He designed and leads the School's online programme Sustainability Leadership and Corporate Responsibility, which has enrolled more than 1,000 senior leaders and board members. He teaches on the School's open programmes, including the Senior Executive Programme. He has also taught custom programmes for more than 25 organisations in energy, finance, technology, industry and consumer goods. His teaching now extends to strategy and its execution with AI. In 2025, he received a Teaching Award at the Financial Times Responsible Business Education Awards. At degree level, he teaches MBA, Executive MBA and PhD students, and he coordinates the MBA's Sustainability and ESG concentration.

Dr. Ioannou speaks regularly to boards, investors and policymakers. He has given numerous keynotes and invited talks across Europe, the Americas, the Middle East and Asia. His audiences include banks and asset managers, consumer and industrial companies, and EU and UK policy bodies. He writes for Forbes, Fortune, Project Syndicate and the Financial Times' Sustainable Views, and he co-chairs the Leaders' Roundtable series at London Business School. In 2024, LinkedIn named him a Top Voice in Sustainability & Business. Across research, teaching and public engagement, he has received multiple awards and honours.